

# HENRIQUE G. LEITÃO

Email: [henrique.leitao@uantwerpen.be](mailto:henrique.leitao@uantwerpen.be)

Website: [hgleitao.github.io](https://hgleitao.github.io)

## CURRENT POSITION

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**PhD** Jan. 2021 – *present* University of Antwerp  
Nov. 2021 – *present* FWO PhD fellow

Supervisor: Prof Hannes Svardal

Project: *The genomic and ecological basis of rapid change in a functionally significant trait: osteoderm evolution in a girdled lizard*

## EDUCATION

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**MSci** **Zoology**, University of Glasgow, *First Class Honours*, 2020.

## SUBMITTED MANUSCRIPTS

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1. Recknagel H, **Leitão HG**, Elmer KR. (2023). 'Genetic basis and expression of ventral colour in polymorphic common lizards'. *Molecular Ecology*. In review.

## PUBLICATIONS

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1. **Leitão HG**, Diedericks G, Broeckhoven C, Baeckens S, Svardal H. (2023). 'Chromosome-level genome assembly of the Cape cliff lizard (*Hemicordylus capensis*)'. *Genome Biology and Biology*, 15(2). <https://doi.org/10.1093/gbe/evad001>
2. Brealey JC, **Leitão HG**, Hofstede T, Kalthoff DC, Guschanski K. (2021). 'The oral microbiota of wild bears in Sweden reflects the history of antibiotic use by humans'. *Current Biology*, 31(20): 4650-4658.e6. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2021.08.010>
3. Brealey JC, **Leitão HG**, van der Valk T, Xu W, Bougiouri K, Dalén L, Guschanski K. (2020). 'Dental calculus as a tool to study the evolution of the mammalian oral microbiome'. *Molecular Biology and Evolution*. 37(10): 3003–3022. <https://doi.org/10.1093/molbev/msaa135>
4. Recknagel H, Layton M, Carey R, **Leitão H**, Sutherland M, Elmer KR. (2018). 'Melanism in common lizards (Squamata: Lacertidae: *Zootoca vivipara*): new evidence for a rare but widespread ancestral polymorphism'. *Herpetology Notes*. 11: 607–612. <https://www.biotaxa.org/hn/article/view/33903>

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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1. **Leitão HG**. (2022). 'Introduction to the ERGA pilot project' *Biodiversity Genomics 2022*, online. (talk)
2. **Leitão HG**, Diedericks G, Broeckhoven C, Baeckens S, Van Damme R, Svardal H. (2022). 'Chromosome-level assembly of the Cape cliff lizard (*Hemicordylus capensis*)'. *Biodiversity Genomics 2022*, online. (poster and lightning talk)
3. **Leitão HG**, Recknagel H, Elmer KR. (2021). 'Genetic mechanisms of colour divergence in common lizards'. *Evolution 2021*, online. (talk)
4. **Leitão HG**, Brealey JC, Guschanski K. (2019). 'Recovering an authentic oral microbiome signature and host genetic diversity from historical dental calculus of non-human mammals'. *Society for Molecular Biology and Evolution (SMBE) Meeting 2019*, Manchester, UK. (poster)
5. **Leitão HG**, Brealey JC, Guschanski K. (2019). 'How to identify 'true' oral taxa in dental calculus?'. *Revolution 2019* (Animal Ecology, Uppsala University internal symposium), Uppsala, Sweden. (poster)

## WORKING GROUPS

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### ERGA

#### European Reference Genome Atlas

2021 - 2023

Duties: UA Svardal Lab representative. Genome assembly, HMW DNA extraction, RNA extraction, Hi-C and RNA-seq lib prep, across 18 species for the ERGA pilot project.

## GENOME ASSEMBLIES

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|                                   |                           |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <i>Hemicordylus capensis</i>      | <a href="#">completed</a> |
| <i>Tripterygion tripteronotum</i> | completed                 |
| <i>Mullus barbatus</i>            | completed                 |
| <i>Knipowitschia panizzae</i>     | completed                 |

## MANUSCRIPT REVIEWS

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|                   |                      |
|-------------------|----------------------|
| Molecular Ecology | 1x (with H. Svardal) |
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## TEACHING ACTIVITIES

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### Guest Lecturer

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| 2022 | Herpetology - 'Evolutionary genomics of amphibians and reptiles' (UAntwerp, 2001WETHER) |
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### Teaching Assistant

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|------|------------------------------------------|
| 2023 | Omics Techniques (UAntwerp, 2201WETOMT)  |
| 2022 | Laboratory Skills (UAntwerp, 2201WETLSK) |
| 2022 | Island Biology (UAntwerp, 2001WETEIL)    |

## FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

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|      |                                                 |           |
|------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 2021 | FWO PhD Fellowship                              | ~115,000€ |
| 2019 | Undergraduate Travel and Mentoring Award SMBE19 | \$1500    |
| 2018 | Erasmus+ Traineeship Grant                      | 5640€     |
| 2016 | Dr Victor Lim Travel Scholarship                | £500      |

## CERTIFICATES

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|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2021 | Genome Assembly using Oxford Nanopore Sequencing, Physalia-courses |
| 2021 | Assembly and Annotation of Genomes, Physalia-courses               |
| 2020 | Python for Genomic Data Science, Coursera                          |
| 2020 | Introduction to Genomic Technologies, Coursera                     |